



San Mateo County CA SO Transparency Portal

Last updated: Sun Jun 21 2026

OVERVIEW

San Mateo County CA SO uses Flock Safety technology to capture objective evidence without compromising on individual privacy. San Mateo County CA SO utilizes retroactive search to solve crimes after they've occurred. Additionally, San Mateo County CA SO utilizes real time alerting of hotlist vehicles to capture wanted criminals. In an effort to ensure proper usage and guardrails are in place, they have made the below policies and usage statistics available to the public.

POLICIES

What's Detected

License Plates, Vehicles

What's Not Detected

Facial recognition, People, Gender, Race

Acceptable Use Policy

Data is used for law enforcement purposes only.
Data is owned by San Mateo County CA SO and is never sold to 3rd parties.

Prohibited Uses

Immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement, harrassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), Personal use.

Access Policy

All system access requires a valid reason and is stored indefinitely.

Hotlist Policy

Hotlist hits are required to be human verified prior to action.

USAGE

Data Retention

The number of days data is retained.

30 days

Total Cameras

Number of LPR and other cameras.

109

Sharing Network Data With

Organizations granted access to San Mateo County CA SO data.

Alameda CA PD	Alameda County CA SO
Albany CA PD	Alhambra CA PD
Anaheim CA PD	Anderson CA PD
Angels Camp CA PD	Antioch CA PD
Arcadia CA PD	Atherton CA PD
Barstow CA PD	Bear Valley Springs CA PD
Beaumont CA PD	Belmont CA PD

Hotlists Alerted On

National and statewide hotlist sources.

California SVS, NCMEC Amber Alert

Vehicles detected in the last 30 days

Number of unique plate reads over the last 30 days.

1,257,131

Number of Hotlist Hits

Total hotlist hits over the last 30 days.

7,199

Number of Searches

Total user search sessions over the last 30 days.

1,341

ADDITIONAL INFO

San Mateo Sheriff's Office ALPR Policy

https://www.smcsheriff.com/sites/default/files/content_files/Automated_License_Plate_Readers_ALPRs_0.pdf

Success Story- Stolen Vehicle

On 06/06/2026, Sheriff's Deputies in unincorporated Redwood City were alerted to a stolen vehicle in the area, via a FLOCK notification. Deputies responded to the area and quickly located the occupied vehicle. Deputies initiated a traffic stop but the driver failed to yield, which led to a short vehicle pursuit. At the conclusion of the pursuit, deputies safely and successfully took the juvenile driver into custody. The driver was also in possession of burglary tools. He was arrested for possession of a stolen vehicle, evading a peace officer with wanton disregard for public safety, and possession of burglary tools. This case highlights the effectiveness of using FLOCK's automated license plate reader (ALPR) technology in supporting public safety and preventing future crimes.

Success Story - Best Buy Serial Computer/Laptop Thief

On 02/23/2024 and 03/23/2024, a suspect entered the Best Buy in San Carlos and stole multiple computers and laptops valued at approximately \$3,000. A suspect vehicle was observed fleeing the scene, and FLOCK enabled deputies to obtain a license plate for the vehicle. Detectives identified a family member of the registered vehicle owner who matched the suspect's description. It was discovered that this suspect had committed similar thefts at Best Buy stores throughout the Bay Area. Detectives and deputies learned of a new suspect vehicle being used by the perpetrator, and FLOCK assisted in identifying this vehicle. In April 2024, deputies and detectives monitored the suspect and the vehicle in question. The suspect returned to the Best Buy in San Carlos on 04/27/2024, where he was arrested for the previous thefts.

Success Story - Arson via Molotov Cocktail

On 05/16/2024, around 3:00am, a suspect threw a Molotov cocktail at a residence in San Carlos. The fire spread rapidly, resulting in the destruction of two vehicles, part of a residential garage, some exterior property, and a section of a tree. Fortunately, the residents managed to escape the area unharmed. Using surveillance video and FLOCK, investigators identified a suspect vehicle that left the area shortly after the incident. With this information, they were able to develop additional leads on the suspect. Search warrants were issued and investigators obtained additional surveillance footage and FLOCK images, which clearly linked the suspect to the arson. This information resulted in the arrest of a suspect, who was prosecuted for arson of an inhabited structure by the San Mateo DA's Office.

Success Story - Residential Burglary/Package Thefts from Apartments

On 08/06/2024 and 08/07/2024, during the early morning hours, two suspects entered different apartment buildings in San Carlos without access or authorization. These suspects entered the mailrooms and stole multiple packages from both buildings. Using surveillance video, detectives obtained descriptions of the suspects and their vehicle. Through FLOCK, a suspect vehicle was located. Detectives and deputies identified one of the involved suspects, who was on post-release community supervision out of Alameda County. They arranged for the probation officer to bring the suspect into the Hayward Probation Office. Detectives contacted the suspect at the office and found additional evidence related to these cases. This case is under review by the District Attorney's Office for prosecution.

Provided by [Flock Safety](#)